

# Laura Escobar

## Curriculum Vitae

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## Education

|                                                                                                                         |                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| University of Toronto   <b>PhD Linguistics</b> (in progress)                                                            | <i>Sept 2024 - present</i>   |
| University of Toronto   <b>M.A. Linguistics</b>                                                                         | <i>Sept 2023 - Aug 2024</i>  |
| University of Toronto   <b>B.A. Linguistics</b> 3.9/4.0 GPA<br><i>Dean's list scholar (2021-2023); High Distinction</i> | <i>Sept 2019 - June 2023</i> |

## Awards

|                                                               |                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Ontario Graduate Scholarship                                  | <i>(\$15,000, Sept 2025)</i> |
| Department Of Linguistics Graduate Fellowship                 | <i>(\$6,000, Sept 2025)</i>  |
| Department Of Linguistics Graduate Award                      | <i>(\$2,100, Sept 2025)</i>  |
| Keren Rice Award Of Linguistics Excellence                    | <i>(\$400 July 2025)</i>     |
| Department Of Linguistics Graduate Program Award              | <i>(\$4,250 April 2024)</i>  |
| SSHRC - Canada Graduate Scholarships-Master's Program         | <i>(\$17,500, Sept 2023)</i> |
| University Of Toronto Fellowship, Faculty Of Arts And Science | <i>(\$10,300, Sept 2023)</i> |

## Research contributions

### Refereed contributions

#### Journal articles

Escobar, L. (Accepted). What makes Kirara sound different from Lyney? Gender Differences in Conversation and Performative Speech in Japanese. *Journal of Japanese Linguistics* (29 pages).

### Non-refereed contributions

#### Conference proceedings

Machado, V. and Escobar, L. (2023). The prosody of Montevideo Spanish: An intonational, rhythmic and tempo description. *2023 Canadian Linguistic Association (CLA) Conference Proceedings* (18 pages). (Co-author; manuscript writing and formatting, data annotation)

### **Conference oral presentations**

- Escobar, L. (2025). Feminine performance: Gender differences in performative and conversational speech in Japanese *anime* and video games. New Ways of Analysing Variation Asia Pacific 8 (NWAV-AP8), Singapore, August. (Accepted)
- Escobar, L. (2025). The voice of the anime girl: How Japanese women's voices are perceived and performed on and off the screen. Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop ([mot<sup>h</sup>] 2025), Toronto, April.
- Escobar, L., Colantoni, L., Pérez Leroux, A. T. & Thomas, D. (2025). Phonetic aspects of gender acquisition in Spanish-English bilinguals. New Sounds 2025 (The 11th International Symposium on the Acquisition of Second Language Speech), Toronto, April.

### **Conference poster presentations**

- Machado, V. and Escobar, L. (2023). The Prosody of Montevideo Spanish: an Intonational and Rhythmic Description. 2023 CLA, Toronto, June.
- Escobar, L. (2023). The intonation of statements in the casual spontaneous speech of Tokyo Japanese. TULCON16, Toronto, March.

### **Workshop presentations**

- Dicks, A., Sanders, N., Escobar, L., Pickavé, M. (2026). Teaching the Next Generation of University Teachers [Workshop panel]. A&S Teaching & Learning Showcase 2025-26, Toronto, May.
- Escobar, L. (2024). Gender differences in f0, intonation and particle use in conversation and performative speech in Japanese. Summer Phonetics/Phonology Forum 2024, Toronto, August.
- Escobar, L. (2025). The voice of the anime girl: Female character archetypes and gender performance on and off the screen. Society of Linguistics Undergraduate Students (SLUGS) Seminar presentation, Toronto, November.

## **Work Experience**

### **Research Assistant**

University of Toronto, Spanish & Portuguese Dept., Linguistics Dept. *Sept 2020 - present*

Contributed to research projects as a research assistant for three projects:

1. Research on syntax and phonetics in Spanish heritage speakers  
(*Prof. Laura Colantoni and Prof. Ana Perez Leroux*)
2. Research on the intonation of Spanish speakers near the border of Uruguay and Brazil  
(*Prof. Laura Colantoni and PhD candidate Vanina Machado*)
3. Research on the prosody of canonical and non-canonical questions in Italian  
(*Prof. Laura Colantoni and Prof. Michela Ippolito*)

## **Teaching Experience**

### **Teaching Assistant**

*Sept 2023 - present*

University of Toronto, Linguistics Dept.

LIN203 - English Words

LIN200 - Introduction to Language

LIN101 - Introduction to Linguistics I

LIN102 - Introduction to Linguistics II

LIN322 - Phonological Theory

English Language Learning (ELL) program lead TA

### **Academic Service**

Abstract reviewer for the 19th Toronto Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (TULCON19),  
*January 2026*

Editor for Toronto Working Papers in Linguistics (TWPL), *2025*

Organizing committee member for Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Syntax Workshop  
(MOTH), *April 2025*

Organizing committee member for Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics  
Workshop ([moth] 2025), *April 2025*

### **Research Interests**

- Sociophonetics
- Prosody and intonation
- Language and gender
- Japanese and Hispanic linguistics

### **Skills**

- Fluent in English, French and Spanish, advanced in Japanese
- Praat scripting and Rstudio
- Digital illustration